

Very visual

Your eyes detect patterns of light and turn them into electrical nerve signals. These pass down the optic nerves to your brain, which converts the signals into a mental image. This means that you “see” with your brain, not just your eyes. The visual processing areas of your brain enable you to see in color and three dimensions (3-D), and your memory lets you recognize what you see.

SEEING IN 3-D

You can see in 3-D because you have two forward-facing eyes with overlapping fields of view. Both eyes see this row of bowling pins, but since each eye sees it from a slightly different angle, they form different images. The eyes turn these images into electronic code, which your brain can combine to create a 3-D view.

FAST FACTS

- The colored iris of your eye has patterns that are unique to you, just like your fingerprints.
- Humans and apes are among the very few mammals that can see red.
- The cone cells that detect color don't work in low light. That's why all color seems to fade out at night.
- Adult human eyes are all the same size. If someone's eyes look big, it's because he or she has a small face.

